Pembrolizumab 400 mg · every 6 weeks · lung cancer

National Cancer Control Programme (NCCP) 00558 · Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending

PRACTICAL TREATMENT GUIDE

Practical treatment planning

Agree the arrangements with your oncology team.

STEP 1

Appointments

Pembrolizumab 400 mg is given as a drip over about 30 minutes on Day 1 every 6 weeks (42 days). The hospital visit is longer because of checks and preparation.

STEP 2

Course length

After complete surgery and platinum chemotherapy, the adjuvant course lasts up to 12 months. For metastatic cancer, treatment continues while it remains helpful and tolerable; the team may consider stopping after 24 months of sustained response without progression, or continuing when appropriate.

STEP 3

Checks between visits

Blood tests are due before each infusion. Thyroid tests stay every 3–6 weeks regardless of dose schedule. Ask about travel, work, transport and whom to contact if a test or visit is delayed.

STEP 4

Home medicines and records

Keep the alert card, symptom record, current medicine list and urgent contact details accessible. Your team may prescribe steroids or hormone replacement only if needed.

STEP 5

After the final dose

Keep reporting new symptoms. Some hormone medicines and monitoring continue after the cancer treatment finishes.

Sources: NCCP 00558 v13 · official regimen. Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending.